

ENGLISH READER

Class-VII



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STATE COUNCIL OF EDUCATIONAL RESEARCH & TRAINING,
ODISHA, BHUBANESWAR

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English Reader

Class - VII

(Experimental Edition)

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PREFACE

The Govt. of Odisha has decided to strengthen the teaching/learning of English in Odia medium Govt. Schools. The English Language Teaching Institute has already prepared a handbook on teaching English at the primary level. About sixty thousand teachers have been trained with the help of the book during 2016-2017 and each teacher has been provided with a copy of the book. Next, the ELTI with the help of SCERT and OPEPA has prepared this new series of textbooks in English from Class-III to Class-VIII based on sound principles of English Language Teaching and principles of pedagogy enshrined in NCF 2005. The books have been tried out with real learners and teachers. Necessary corrections have been made accordingly. I wish the teachers to read the introduction and notes for them provided in the books and teach the books accordingly. I also want the Inspecting Officials to go through the textbooks and supervise classes accordingly. The workbooks are carefully built into the textbooks. The teachers should use the books following a learner-centred approach and make learners do the tasks. They should correct learners' scripts and provide feedback. The Inspecting Officials are expected to supervise this regularly. Each textbook has also inbuilt tests to test the performance of both the learners and the teachers. Language indicators for each class are also provided at the end of the book for the guidance of both the teachers and Inspecting Officials. This will help the parents to check the progress of their wards. Attempts are also being made to prepare similar textbooks in other subjects from the coming years based on these sound principles. But unfortunately, our attempts to strengthen teaching/learning through good textbooks fail to yield expected results due to widespread prevalence of cheap bazaar notes (Meaning Books) prepared only with the motives of commercial gains. These books provide cheap ready-made helps by working out the tasks/activities thereby preventing students from getting/developing skill and restrict them from the pleasure of doing the workbook tasks/activities on their own.

I am sure, the new series will help our learners excel in all the four language skills of English --- Listening, Speaking, Reading and Writing. I thank the Editors and the Reviewers for their sincere efforts in preparing the excellent materials. I also thank Dr. Manmatha Kundu, the Academic Adviser and Mr. Indramani Tripathy, the Director of ELTI under whose academic and administrative guidance the books are prepared.

Any suggestions for the improvement of the book are welcome.

Commissioner-cum-Secretary
Department of School and Mass Education
Govt. of Odisha



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INTRODUCTION

The Secret of Language Learning

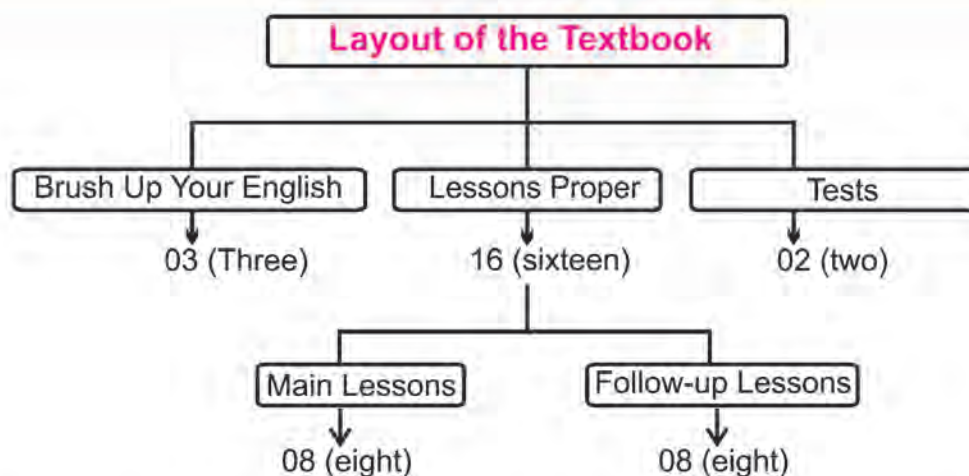
Language is mostly learned through exposure and use in meaningful contexts. While the exposure to language is mainly done through listening and reading, use is done through speaking and writing. The more one listens to a language and reads in a language, the more s/he gets exposed to the language. Exposure lays the foundation of a language and also the foundation for using the language. One cannot use (speak) the language unless one has sufficiently listened to the language. One cannot write in the language unless one has widely read in the language. And both the exposure and use are to be done in meaningful contexts. What one listens and reads should be useful and interesting to him/her. Similarly, what one speaks and writes should also be interesting and useful for the user. In other words, all these are to be done in contexts and the user should be involved in activities. This is the secret behind learning any language.

The question, therefore, is how we can restructure our teaching and learning of English. First, our learners should be sufficiently exposed to English through listening. In case of acquiring mother tongue, a child listens to the language for long to be able to speak. Listening to the language lays the foundation for speaking. Do we provide enough exposure to English through listening before teaching our learners to speak and write in our schools? Certainly not. We usually tend to start teaching of English from reading and writing. This is why our learners face difficulties in learning English in Odia medium schools. In order to do this, we have to reverse the current trend of teaching English. Instead of beginning teaching of reading and writing, we should first develop the listening and speaking skills of our learners through storytelling and TPR (Total Physical Response) activities. The current primer of English (Class- III) has, therefore, been revised and rewritten with enough pre-primer activities (Storytelling, Rhymes, Known English Words, TPR etc.) before learners learn to read and write.

The Textbook

The class VII English textbook has also been revised and rewritten keeping in mind the development of listening and speaking skills of our learners along with the skills of reading and writing. In this book, there are enough listening and speaking activities provided under each lesson. The lessons in the book are reorganised as follows:

The three "Brush up your English" lessons are simple and interesting. There are poems, and stories with very interesting mind-engaging activities, hence the name. The main purpose of this section is to help learners learn what they have not learned before. Currently, majority of learners are below their class level, in terms of skills, more so in



English classes. If their skills are not levelled up through right kind of learning, the main lessons will not work and the teacher will take recourse to reading aloud, explaining the text often in Odia and somehow complete the course as they were accustomed to doing before. The tasks provided, therefore, are tasks for beginners (Class- III and class- IV) such as handwriting, writing words, phrases and simple sentences mostly of copying kind- Listen and Talk, See and Write. These three “Brush up your English” lessons serve as steps for reaching the lessons proper.

Lessons Proper

There are eight lessons – four prose pieces and four poems. These pieces are very carefully chosen, the main criteria of selection are simplicity (language) and interest value for the young learners of 12-13 years old. Each lesson has three major sections: Pre-reading, While-reading and Post-reading. The purpose of pre-reading is motivating the learners to read the text. The while-reading phase is devoted to interactive reading. The learner is taught to interact (communicate) with the writer through the text. This is the most important phase of the lesson. If this part is not properly done, the next phase, post-reading becomes futile. The post-reading phase is devoted to interesting learning activities based on the text. While doing these activities, the learner reads and rereads the text on his/her own without being conscious of the fact that s/he is reading so many times. The activities become the main product and learning skills come as by-product.

Follow-up Lessons

These are, in fact, sub-lessons of the main lessons. In this book, one sub-lesson is given under each main lesson. This is also called follow-up lesson. The sub-lessons are shorter and simpler than the main lessons. The themes are related to the themes of

the main lessons. Compared to the main lessons, the sub-lessons are less controlled in the sense that both the teacher and learners are given freedom to work on their own, the primary purpose being the development of autonomous learning. While the questions and activities are provided in the main lessons by the editors, teachers are encouraged to frame their own questions and activities for sub-lessons. Similarly, the learners are encouraged to read and comprehend the text and do the activities on their own with less guidance from the teachers. Learners are encouraged to self-correct and peer-correct their own writings. The other purpose of these sub-lessons is to relate the main text to their daily life experiences and use of English. In other words, they are discouraged to be textbook centric.

Tests

There are two tests, one after the 3rd lesson and the other at the end. The tests are of 100 marks each. The tests intend to test the English language skills of the learners, the skills expected to be developed through these lessons. The test results will provide feedback to both the learners and the teachers- the learners will get the feedback whether they have developed the English language skills studying the text or not and the teacher will get the feedback whether they have been successful in helping the learners develop the expected English language skills or not. The tests will also help teachers to frame similar tests to be administered to students on a regular basis.

Interlinking Materials and Methods

During the early phase of textbook writing, methods of teaching were not reflected in the textbooks. So the teachers used their own ways of handling the text. Attempts have, therefore, been made in the book to link the material with method. The material writers while preparing the textbook, visualised the method that the teacher is to use to transact the material in the classroom. In fact, now it is realized that method is more important than the materials shown through the mathematical calculations: Good Materials + Bad Method= No result, Bad Materials+ Good Method= Some results. As a result, only those persons having first-hand experience of teaching are asked to prepare materials, and try them out with real learners. The general approach suggested is learner-centred and activity-oriented approach with some specific techniques of teaching such as BS (Brainstorming), Chain-drill, VMDT (Visual Memory Development Technique) and MT (Mental Talk). A brief description of these four techniques is provided in Appendix-II; Notes on Techniques.

ପ୍ରିୟ ଛାତ୍ରଛାତ୍ରୀ

ତୁମେମାନେ ସହଜରେ କିପରି ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶିଖିବ, ସେଥିପାଇଁ ଏ ବହିଟି ପ୍ରସ୍ତୁତ କରାଯାଇଛି । ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶିଖିବା ସମ୍ବନ୍ଧରେ ତୁମମାନଙ୍କୁ ଆମେ କିଛି କହିବାକୁ ଚାହୁଁ । ତୁମେ ସବୁ ଶୁଣିବତ ?

ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶିଖିବା କ'ଣ ପାଇଁ ଦରକାର ? ଏ ବିଷୟରେ ନିଶ୍ଚୟ ତୁମମାନଙ୍କର କିଛି ଧାରଣା ଅଛି । ପ୍ରଥମ କଥା ହେଲା ଡ଼ାକ୍ତରୀ ଶ୍ରେଣୀଠାରୁ କଲେଜ ପାଠ ଶେଷ ହେବା ପର୍ଯ୍ୟନ୍ତ ଇଂରାଜୀ ତୁମମାନଙ୍କପାଇଁ ଏକ ବାଧ୍ୟତାମୂଳକ ବିଷୟ । ଏହା ବ୍ୟତୀତ ତୁମେମାନେ ଯଦି ମାଟ୍ରିକ ପାଠ ପରେ ପୁଣ୍ୟତୁ ଠାରୁ ବିଜ୍ଞାନ ପଢ଼ିବା ପାଇଁ ଚାହଁବ, ସେ ପାଠସବୁ ତୁମମାନଙ୍କୁ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଭାଷା ମାଧ୍ୟମରେ ପଢ଼ିବାପାଇଁ ପଢ଼ିବ ଏବଂ ତାପରେ ଯଦି ମେଡ଼ିକାଲ ବା ଇଞ୍ଜିନିୟରିଂ ପଢ଼ିବ, ସେସବୁ ପାଠ ତୁମମାନଙ୍କୁ ଇଂରାଜୀରେ ହିଁ ପଢ଼ିବାକୁ ପଡ଼ିବ । ଆମ ରାଜ୍ୟ ବାହାରକୁ ଗଲେ ତୁମମାନଙ୍କୁ ଇଂରାଜୀରେ କଥାବାର୍ତ୍ତା କରିବାକୁ ପଡ଼ିବ । ବଡ଼ ହୋଇ ଚାକିରୀ କଲେ ଚାକିରୀର କାମପାଇଁ ଇଂରାଜୀ ନିହାତି ଜାଣିବାକୁ ପଡ଼ିବ । ଆଉ ଯଦି ଚାକିରୀ ପାଇଁ ଦେଶ ବାହାରକୁ ଯିବାକୁ ପଡ଼ିବ, ଇଂରାଜୀ ନହେଲେ ନ ଚଳେ ।

ତେଣୁ ପ୍ରଶ୍ନ ଉଠେ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶିଖିବା କେମିତି ? ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶିଖିବା ବିଷୟରେ ଆମମାନଙ୍କର କିଛି ଭୁଲ୍ ଧାରଣା ଅଛି । ଆଗ ସେସବୁ ଭୁଲ୍ ଧାରଣାକୁ ଦୂର କରିବାକୁ ପଡ଼ିବ । ପ୍ରଥମ ଭୁଲ୍ ଧାରଣା ହେଲା, ଇଂରାଜୀ ଗୋଟିଏ କଷ୍ଟ ବିଷୟ । ସତରେ ତାହା ନୁହେଁ । ଅନେକ ଦିନରୁ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଭାଷା ଓଡ଼ିଆ ଠାରୁ ସହଜ । ପ୍ରଥମ କଥା ହେଲା, ଇଂରାଜୀ ଅକ୍ଷର ଲେଖା ଓଡ଼ିଆ ଅକ୍ଷର ଲେଖା ଠାରୁ ସହଜ । ଯିଏ ଓଡ଼ିଆ ଲେଖା ଶିଖି ସାରିଛି ଇଂରାଜୀ ଲେଖା ତା ପାଇଁ କିଛି ନୁହେଁ । ଓଡ଼ିଆ ଲେଖାରେ କଷ୍ଟ ହେଲା ଯୁକ୍ତାକ୍ଷର । ଇଂରାଜୀରେ ଯୁକ୍ତାକ୍ଷର ନାହିଁ କହିଲେ ଚଳେ । ଆମର ଆଉ ଗୋଟିଏ ଭୁଲ୍ ଧାରଣା ହେଲା ଗୋଟିଏ ଭାଷା ଅନ୍ୟ ଭାଷାଠାରୁ ବେଶ୍ ଅଲଗା । ଏଇ ଯେମିତି ଆମେ ଭାବୁ ଓଡ଼ିଆ ଠାରୁ ଇଂରାଜୀ ବେଶ୍ ଅଲଗା । ସତରେ ତାହା ନୁହେଁ । ସବୁ ଭାଷାମାନଙ୍କ ମଧ୍ୟରେ ପାଖାପାଖି ଅଣା ପ୍ରତିଶତ ସାମଞ୍ଜସ୍ୟ ରହିଛି । ଭାଷାମାନଙ୍କର ମୁଖ୍ୟ ଦକ୍ଷତା (ଶୁଣିବା, କହିବା, ପଢ଼ିବା, ଲେଖିବା) ମାନଙ୍କ ମଧ୍ୟରେ ମଧ୍ୟ ସେମିତି ସାମଞ୍ଜସ୍ୟ ରହିଛି । ଏହାର ଅର୍ଥ ହେଲା ଗୋଟିଏ ଭାଷା ଜାଣିଥିବା ଲୋକପାଇଁ ଅନ୍ୟ ଭାଷା ଶିଖିବା ସହଜ । ଯଦି ଜଣେ ଓଡ଼ିଆ ଭାଷା ଶିଖିଛି, ତା ପାଇଁ ଇଂରାଜୀ ବା ଯେ କୌଣସି ଭାଷା ଶିଖିବା ସହଜ ।

ଆମମାନଙ୍କର ଆଉ ଗୋଟିଏ ଭୁଲ୍ ଧାରଣା ହେଲା, ସ୍କୁଲକୁ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶିଖିବାପାଇଁ ଆସିବା ପୂର୍ବରୁ ଆମେ କିଛି ଇଂରାଜୀ ଜାଣି ନାହୁଁ । ଇଂରାଜୀ ଆମମାନଙ୍କ ପାଇଁ ପୁରାପୁରି ଗୋଟିଏ ନୂଆ ବିଷୟ । ଏ ଧାରଣା କିନ୍ତୁ ଠିକ୍ ନୁହେଁ । ଆମ ବାତାବରଣରୁ ତୁମେ ସବୁ କେତେ କଣ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶବ୍ଦ ଶିଖି ସାରିଛ । ଏଇ ଦେଖୁନ, କେବଳ ସାଇକେଲ୍ ସମ୍ବନ୍ଧରେ ତୁମେମାନେ କେତେ କଣ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶବ୍ଦ ଜାଣିଛ । ସାଇକେଲ୍‌ର ସବୁ ପାର୍ଟସ୍‌ର ନାମ କହିଲ । ବହୁ ପାର୍ଟସ୍‌ର ଓଡ଼ିଆ ଆମେ ଜାଣିନୁ । ଏଇ ଯେମିତି ହାଣ୍ଡେଲ୍, ବ୍ରେକ୍, ଟ୍ୟୁବ୍, ଟାୟାର ଇତ୍ୟାଦି ଇତ୍ୟାଦି । ସେମିତି ତମେ ଯାନବାହାନ, ଖାଦ୍ୟପେୟ, ଡ୍ରେସ୍, ଖେଳ, ଡାକ୍ତରଖାନା, ସିନେମା, ଟିଭି, ଟ୍ରେନ୍ ଆଦି ବିଷୟରେ କେତେ କଣ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶବ୍ଦ ଶିଖିଛ । କେବଳ ମୋବାଇଲ୍ ପାଇଁ କେତେ କଣ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶବ୍ଦ ଅଛି, ଦେଖିଲ । ସ୍କୁଲରେ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶିଖିବା ପୂର୍ବରୁ ଚାନ, ରୁଷିଆ ଭଳି ଦେଶମାନଙ୍କର ଛାତ୍ରଛାତ୍ରୀ କମ୍ ସଂଖ୍ୟକ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶବ୍ଦ ଜାଣିଥିଲା ବେଳେ ତୁମେମାନେ ପାଖାପାଖି ହଜାରେ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶବ୍ଦ ଶିଖିସାରିଛ, ତେଣୁ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶିଖିବା କାହାପାଇଁ ସହଜ-ତୁମମାନଙ୍କ ପାଇଁ ନା ସେମାନଙ୍କ ପାଇଁ ?

ଆମମାନଙ୍କର ଗୋଟିଏ ଭୁଲ୍ ଧାରଣା ହେଲା ଇଂରାଜୀ ମିଡ଼ିୟମ୍ ସ୍କୁଲରେ ପାଠ ପଢ଼ିଲେ ବା ଇଂରାଜୀ ପ୍ରଥମ ଶ୍ରେଣୀରୁ ପଢ଼ିଲେ, ଆମର ଇଂରାଜୀ ଭଲ ହେବ, ତାହା ଠିକ୍ ନୁହେଁ । ବରଂ ପ୍ରଥମରୁ ମାତୃଭାଷାରେ ବେଶ୍ କିଛି ବର୍ଷ ଭଲ ପାଠ ପଢ଼ି ପରେ ଇଂରାଜୀ ପଢ଼ିଲେ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଭାଷା ଜ୍ଞାନ ଭଲ ହୁଏ । ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶିଖିବାଟା କେତେ ତଳକୁସରୁ ଶିଖିଲେ, ତା ଉପରେ ନିର୍ଭର କରେ ନାହିଁ । ନିର୍ଭର କରେ ଇଂରାଜୀ କେମିତି ପଢ଼ାଯାଉଛି, ତା ପାଠ୍ୟପୁସ୍ତକ, ପାଠ ପଢ଼ି ଓ ଶିକ୍ଷକଙ୍କର ଦକ୍ଷତା ଉପରେ । ଏହା ବ୍ୟତିତ ତୁମର ନିଷ୍ଠା ଓ ଆଗ୍ରହ ତୁମ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶିକ୍ଷଣ ପ୍ରକ୍ରିୟାକୁ ସହଜ କରାଇବ ।